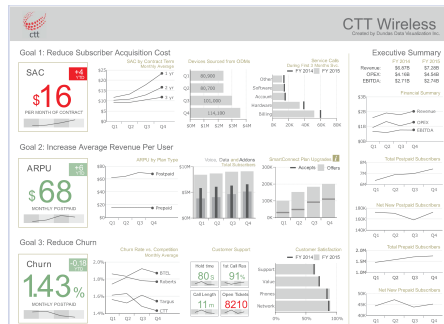


Chapter 27 Case Study

Telecom Operator Executive Dashboard

Dashboard design for executive decision-making

Presenter: Tran Nguyen My Anh
Course: Data Visualization / Dashboard Design
Source: *The Big Book of Dashboards*, Chapter 27



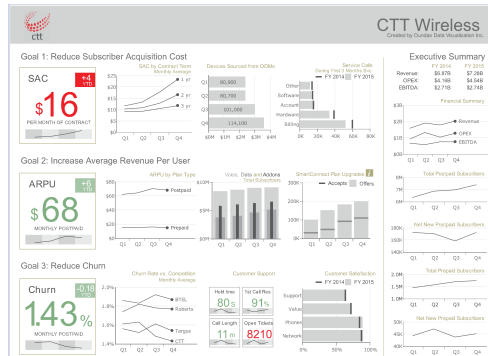
Scenario and Business Context

Who uses it?

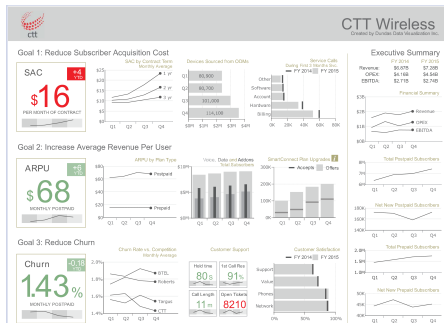
- Executives and senior management at a telecom company.
- Used in management, board, or stakeholder meetings.
- The goal is executive-level monitoring, not deep interactive analysis.

What must it answer quickly?

- Is the company on track against strategic goals?
- Which metrics are improving or worsening?



Dashboard Design Logic

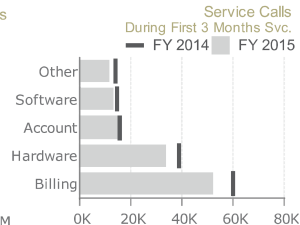
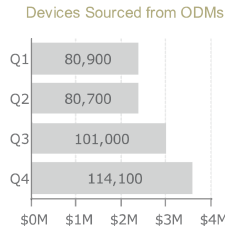
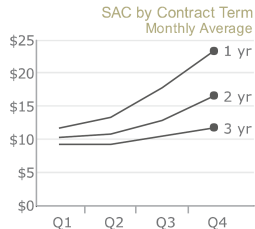


The dashboard is structured around four information zones

- Row 1: **Reduce Subscriber Acquisition Cost.**
- Row 2: **Increase Average Revenue Per User.**
- Row 3: **Reduce Churn.**
- Right column: **Executive Summary** for finance and subscriber status.

Goal 1: Reduce SAC

Goal 1: Reduce Subscriber Acquisition Cost



Status

- **\$16**/month of contract.
- **+4 YTD** above benchmark.

Drivers

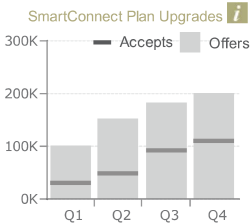
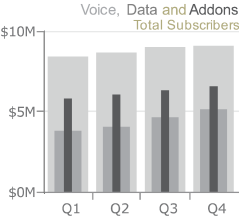
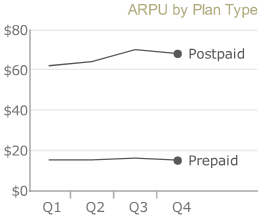
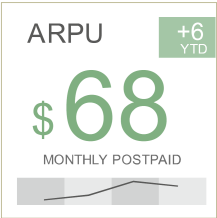
- Contract term changes cost.
- ODM device mix adds pressure.

Operational signal

- Service calls show burden.
- Target lines show FY2014 gap.

Goal 2: Increase ARPU

Goal 2: Increase Average Revenue Per User



Status

- \$68 monthly postpaid.
- +6 YTD revenue lift.

Revenue mix

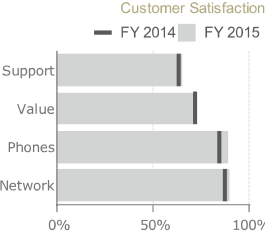
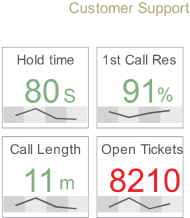
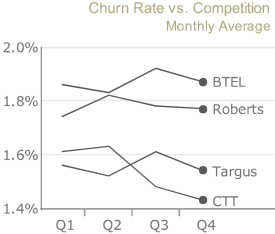
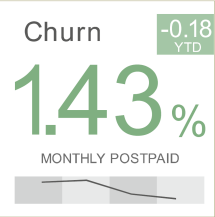
- Postpaid/prepaid split.
- Add-ons show contribution.

Conversion

- Offers compared with accepts.
- Gaps show upgrade room.

Goal 3: Reduce Churn

Goal 3: Reduce Churn



Status

- 1.43% monthly churn.
- -0.18 YTD improvement.

Competitive view

- CTT benchmarked vs peers.
- Direct labels avoid a legend.

Retention risk

- Support KPIs show friction.
- Satisfaction flags churn risk.

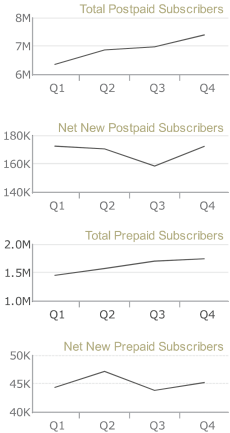
Executive Summary

Executive Summary

	FY 2014	FY 2015
Revenue:	\$6.87B	\$7.28B
OPEX:	\$4.16B	\$4.54B
EBITDA:	\$2.71B	\$2.74B



Finance: revenue, OPEX, and EBITDA stay visible as executive context.



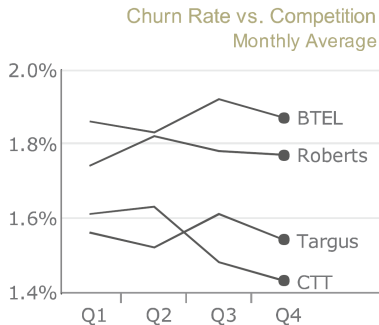
Executive read

- 01 Financial health
- 02 Subscriber base
- 03 Net additions

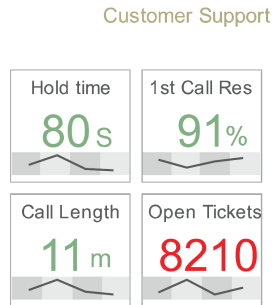
Use: company context for the three goal rows.

Do not use: detailed diagnosis by itself.

Why This Works: Compact but Informative



Direct labels. Line-end labels remove the legend lookup and keep each series attached to its endpoint.



Small KPI cards. Sparklines add trend context while keeping four support measures in a tight space.

Layout Supports Quick Reading

Design principles used

- **Proximity:** related charts are placed near one another.
- **Closure:** each goal is perceived as a separate group.
- **Alignment:** rows and columns make scanning predictable.
- **Visual hierarchy:** KPI cards appear first, summary stays on the right.

Reading paths: scan horizontally to analyze one goal; scan the right column for company-wide status.

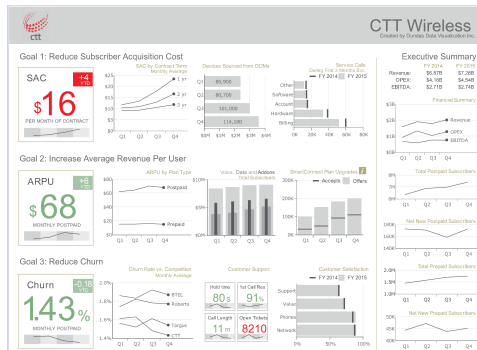
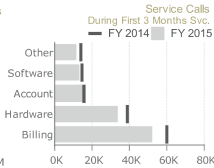
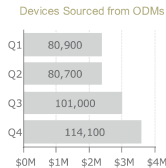
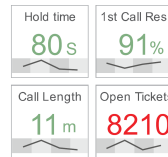


Chart Type Selection

Goal 1: Reduce Subscriber Acquisition Cost



Customer Support



Goal row: KPI card, trend line, comparison bars, and target line are read as one decision unit.

Line charts

Trends over time.

Bar charts

Category and target comparisons.

Sparklines

Compact trend cues.

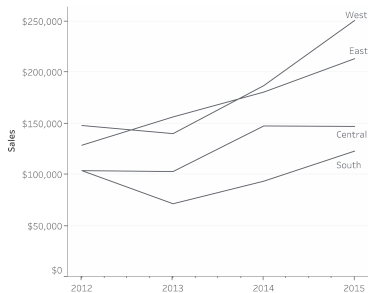
Target lines

Current values versus benchmark.

KPI cards: sparklines provide compact trend context without opening a separate chart.

Critique and Design Lessons

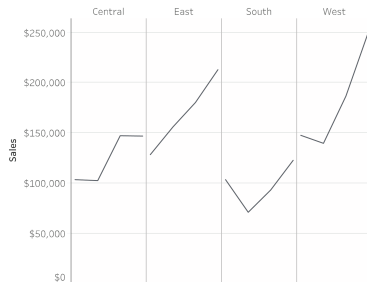
Sales by Region



Problem: overlapping lines are hard to trace when several regions cross in the same plot.

Other critiques: red/green needs a non-color cue, and emphasis colors should be used sparingly.

Sales by Region, 2012-2015



Fix: split dense series into small multiples so each region keeps a consistent time axis.

Conclusion

What Chapter 27 teaches

- A good dashboard helps decision-makers understand what is improving, what is worsening, and where action is needed.
- This dashboard succeeds because it follows three clear business goals.
- The three-row plus one-summary-column layout makes scanning fast.
- Small charts, direct labels, and limited color reduce clutter.
- The design still requires care with accessibility, overlapping lines, and chart consistency.

References

- Steve Wexler, Jeffrey Shaffer, Andy Cotgreave. *The Big Book of Dashboards*, Chapter 27: Telecom Operator Executive Dashboard.
- Dundas Data Visualization sample dashboard: Telecom / Wireless Executive Strategy Dashboard.
- O'Reilly online excerpt for Chapter 27:
<https://www.oreilly.com/library/view/the-big-book/9781119282716/c27.xhtml>
- Dashboard design references: related metric grouping, proximity, clutter reduction, clear KPI structure, and accessibility.

Thank you